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Solution Architect (Cloud)

Cabinet Office

Apply before 11:55 pm on Friday 22nd May 2026

Reference number

458583

Salary

£57,204 - £63,953

Offers above the Band minimum are subject to our assessment of your skills and experience as demonstrated at interview. Salaries over the Band minimum will be paid as a non-pensionable allowance

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Fixed term

Loan

Length of employment

24 months

Business area

CO - Digital

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Full-time

Number of jobs available

2

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Location

Existing CO Staff can work in their original contractual work location.
Existing Civil Servants working in all other departments can work in Bristol, Manchester, Newcastle, York, Glasgow and Norwich.
External candidates can work in Bristol, Manchester, Newcastle, York, Glasgow and Norwich.

About the job

Job summary

The Cabinet Office is modernising the platform used by over 10,000 civil servants each day, replacing Google Workspace with Microsoft 365 and provisioning access via a resilient zero-trust network. If you are a self motivated Cloud Architect who can help this project, we would like to hear from you.

The Cabinet Office is at the centre of government. Its purpose is: to maintain the integrity of the Union, co-ordinate the security of the realm and sustain a flourishing democracy; to support the design and implementation of HM Government's policies and the Prime Minister's priorities; and to ensure the delivery of the finest public services by attracting and developing the best public servants and improving the efficiency of government.

Falcon is being run by Cabinet Office Digital, in collaboration with the Desnz Integrated Corporate Services (ICS) team.

The work pattern is Hybrid with a mixture of home working and collaboration sessions based in London and Bristol.

Job description

What you ll do

write and own high level and detailed designs and specifications for the platform

create/maintain core architecture artefacts including data/identity flows, and security controls

produce option appraisals with clear trade-offs (cost, risk, resilience, performance, operability)

drive and own governance and compliance to standards set by the Cabinet Office

collaborate with ICS on delivery, champion our requirements, review the output and test the solutions

champion best practice and quality delivery

balance trade-offs of cost, quality and risk, with a particular focus on Cyber security and incremental delivery

excite and energise the team, bringing people together and fostering collaboration

be an early adopter and evaluator of the platform

engage in cyber risk reduction through Cyber Threat Modelling and collaborating with the Cyber Defence team

provide support and knowledge to assurance teams focused on Information Assurance, Data Protection and AI Policy

define technical standards and guardrails for the zero-trust/SASE platform, ensuring alignment with enterprise architecture, information security policies, and legal compliance (e.g. UK GDPR/Data Protection Act)

Person specification

Who you are

a hands on cloud architect with an eye for the big picture, who can drill into detail as required

a collaborative person who is excited about working within a team as part of a wider network of teams

self motivated and resilient with a track record of delivery in complex and highly regulated organisation

a problem solver who is able to leverage the people, process and technology to get the job done

Requirements

passionate and knowledgeable about Cloud Architecture

familiar with zero-trust network concepts and identity centric designs

significant experience as a Cloud/Enterprise Architect or equivalent, delivering large-scale cloud-first end-user compute and identity solutions

experience of developing designs for Microsoft Cloud Architecture (M365, Azure, Power Platform and EntraID)

experienced with mobile device management solutions for Laptops (Windows & IOS) and mobile devices (Android & IOS)

experience of engaging with business analysts and tailoring product offering to their needs

familiar with Google Workspace (AKA Google Suite)

strong analytical skills, able to drill to detail when problem solving

strong strategic thinking and ability to analyse and interpret data

It s desirable that you have:

worked with Okta identity management and SSO

worked with Zscaler [Zero-Trust Exchange platform](#)

familiarity of the public sector and government processes,

Additional information:

Cabinet Office policy is that a minimum 60% of your working time should be spent at your principal workplace. For some roles, due to their nature and the business need, this may be up to 100%. Requirements to attend other locations for official business will also count towards this level of attendance.

Curious about Government Digital and Data? Dive into the Candidate Pack to learn more. <https://dsit.pagetiger.com/bzwfhzv/1>

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

- Seeing the Big Picture

- Working Together

- Changing and Improving

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

- Cloud awareness

- Identity management and zero-trust networking

- Designing solutions

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £57,204, Cabinet Office contributes £16,571 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides.](#)

- Learning and development tailored to your role.

- An environment with flexible working options.

- A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity.

- A [Civil Service Pension](#) which provides an attractive pension, benefits for dependants and employer contributions of 28.97%.

A minimum of 25 days of paid annual leave, increasing by one day per year up to a maximum of 30.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

Application process

As part of the application process, you will be asked to provide:

1. A CV

Further details around what this will entail are listed on the application form.

Applications will be sifted on the CV.

Selection process

We will assess you against the following Behaviours and Technical skills:

Seeing The Big Picture

Working Together

Changing and Improving

We will assess you against these Technical Skills during the selection process. These are aligned with the Government Digital and Data Profession Capability Framework of Technical Architect role family:

Cloud awareness

Identity management & zero-trust networking

Designing solutions

The format of the interview will be questions on the behaviours and technical skills listed above, as well as a presentation. Please prepare a 15 minute presentation that describes a solution or design you know well.

Expected timeline (subject to change)

Expected sift date 18/05/2026

Expected interview date/s 08/06/2026

Interview location - Your interview will either be conducted face to face or by video. You will be notified of the location if you are selected for interview.

Reasonable adjustments

If a person with disabilities is put at a substantial disadvantage compared to a non-disabled person, we have a duty to make reasonable changes to our processes.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should:

Contact Government Recruitment Service
via cabinetofficerecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk as soon as possible
before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Complete the Assistance required section in the Additional requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need further on in the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at interview, or if you're deaf, a Language Service Professional.

Further information

If you are experiencing accessibility problems with any attachments on this advert, please contact the email address in the 'contact point for applicants' section.

Please note that this role requires SC clearance, which would normally need 5 years UK residency in the past 5 years. This is not an absolute requirement, but supplementary checks may be needed where individuals have not lived in the UK for that period. This may mean your security clearance (and therefore your appointment) will take longer or, in some cases, not be possible.

For further information on National Security Vetting please [visit the Demystifying Vetting website](#).

Any move to Cabinet Office from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare; for further information [visit the Childcare Choices website](#).

A reserve list will be held for a period of 12 months, from which further appointments can be made.

If successful and transferring from another Government Department a criminal record check may be carried out.

In order to process applications without delay, we will be sending a Criminal Record Check to Disclosure and Barring Service/Disclosure Scotland on your behalf.

However, we recognise in exceptional circumstances some candidates will want to send their completed forms direct. If you will be doing this, please advise Government Recruitment Service of your intention by emailing Pre-EmploymentChecks.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk stating the job reference number in the subject heading.

For further information on the Disclosure Scotland confidential checking service telephone: the Disclosure Scotland Helpline on 0870 609 6006 and

ask to speak to the operations manager in confidence, or email Info@disclosurescotland.co.uk

New entrants are expected to join on the minimum of the pay band.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant's details held on the IFD will be refused employment.

A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5 year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

Existing Civil Servants and applicants from accredited NDPBs are eligible to apply, but will only be considered on loan basis (Civil Servants) or secondment (accredited NDPBs). Prior agreement to be released on a loan basis must be obtained before commencing the application process. In the case of Civil Servants, the terms of the loan will be agreed between the home and host department and the Civil Servant. This includes grade on return.

This role is full time only. Applicants who wish to work an alternative pattern are welcome to apply however your preferred working pattern may not be available and you should discuss this with the vacancy holder before applying.

Please note terms and conditions are attached. Please take time to read the document to determine how these may affect you.

Feedback

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in

the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : CO Digital Recruitment Team

Email : codigitalrecruitment@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : cabinetofficerecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel that your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles, and wish to make a complaint, then in the first instance you should contact Government Recruitment Service by email at :

cabinetofficerecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive, then you can contact the Civil Service Commission at info@csc.gov.uk. For further information on the Recruitment Principles and bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission, please visit their website at: <https://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/>.

